

Halloween 2026 giant alley spider

Brief for a 3D visualizer. All locked sizes are multiples of full body length (front of the head to the back of the abdomen). Lengths in meters are not locked yet: the spider must span an alley about 3 m wide and still leave a walking path underneath.

What it is

A giant two-segment spider hung over an alley so people can walk underneath it. The proportion study is a black silhouette with no eyes, fangs, hair, or texture. Last year a ghost about 5 m long with a 3 m arm span hung in the same alley. The body hangs in the middle, about 2.3 m up. Four legs go to each building at staggered heights, one visible knee on each leg. Feet land on the two alley walls.

Site

Impasse du Rossignol, off 1 Rue de Trousse Chemise, 17880 Les Portes-en-Re, France (Ile de Re). IGN Lambert-93 about x 353752.51, y 6582086.15. Measured from an IGN orthophoto at 5 cm per pixel: the roof-to-roof gap is about 3 m along the stretch to be used (about 3.3 m at the street, about 2.9 m in the tighter part). Walking width is about the same, because the walls sit close to the roof edges. Two-story buildings stand on both sides.

Locked proportions (units of body length)

Full body length is 1. Legs are 3.25. Two body segments only. Abdomen: length 0.76, width 0.494. Head (cephalothorax): length 0.30, width 0.326, which is 0.66 of the abdomen width. The segments overlap by 0.06, so $0.30 + 0.76 - 0.06 = 1$. The body is a cylinder: in front view the abdomen height equals its width (0.494) and the head height equals its width (0.326). The visible front-view cross-section is the abdomen, not the head. The head may peek above the abdomen, but the circle you see is the abdomen.

Legs and joints

Eight legs. Each leg is one straight segment from the body to a knee, then one straight segment from the knee to the foot. The knee sits at 48 percent of the leg length (a drawing constant, not a chosen design value). Knees are lifted and feet are on the walls, so the legs reach across rather than stand. The front pair is straighter than the back pair. Bend is measured in degrees off a straight leg (0 means straight). The front pair uses half the back-pair bend. If the back pair is 60 degrees off straight (interior angle about 120 degrees), the front pair is 30 degrees off straight. The numbered bend has not been chosen. The series under consideration is back-leg bends of 15, 30, 45, 60, 75, 90, and 105 degrees, with the front pair at half of each. A working suggestion, not locked, is about 60 degrees off straight on the back pair. Leg thickness is not chosen. Sketches used a thin stroke.

Not locked

Knee angle (the series above). Leg thickness. Absolute size in meters, once the 3 m alley and walk-under clearance are applied. Construction materials are out of scope for the visualizer.

Suggested model

Place two opposing walls 3 m apart. Hang the cylindrical body on the centerline. Attach four legs per side. Bend the back pair more than the front pair, using the half-angle rule above, and show the abdomen as the front cross-section. Keep every locked ratio above. Leave the knee angle and leg thickness as parameters.